Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on March 20, 2023

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Regional Councillor	J. Dies
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		L. Bower
		N. Henry
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Dies called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 2023 Operating Budget and 2023 Capital Budget; 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast Meeting

Moved by: R. Tyler-Morin

That the Minutes of the 2023 Operating Budget and 2023 Capital Budget; 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast meeting of the General Government Committee held on February 16, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Regular Meeting

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on February 21, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.3 **Closed Session**

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on February 21, 2023 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.5, 4.6, 4.7, 4.10 and 4.11 for discussion.

4.1 **CAO-2023-02: Council Ward Constituent Newsletter Update**

Committee Members posed questions respecting the options identified by staff including the process undertaken to select the company identified in Option C, previous mechanisms employed by the Town to distribute newsletters, the total number of subscribers to the Town's electronic newsletters, availability of supplemental copies for distribution to senior's residences and opportunities to supply newsletters in languages other than English, as well as the ability to develop and distribute ward-specific content. D. Jarvis, Supervisor of Communications and Engagement, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council defer consideration of Report CAO-2023-02 to the Council meeting scheduled for March 27, 2023.

CARRIED

4.2 **CAO-2023-03: Vaccination Policy**

Committee Members posed questions respecting the number of staff impacted by the policy and opportunities to reinstate employees following suspension of the policy, the results of recent arbitration decisions involving other Ontario municipalities, the position of the Town's legal counsel on the proposed suspension and actions taken by other municipalities within the Region of Durham. Mary Lou Consentino, Manager, Human Resource Services and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That Council approves the suspension of the Town's Vaccination Policy.

CARRIED

4.3 **CAO-2023-04: OMERS By-law**

Committee Members sought clarification concerning the timing of registered retirement

savings plan contributions, opt-out provisions, clarification on next steps, and the effective participation date following adoption of the by-law by Council. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the proposed OMERS By-law (ATT-1) which provides the Town of Ajax authorization to participate in the OMERS plan effective January 1, 2023, be brought forward to the March 27th, 2023 Council meeting for approval.

CARRIED

4.4 FIN-2023-06: 2022 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees

Moved by: S. Collier

That the 2022 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 OES-2023-09: Contract Award – AVL & Dashcams Award

Committee Members posed questions to staff respecting the changing value of the contract and anticipated benefits associated with the proposed system, one-time and ongoing costs required to support the system, the total number of vehicles to be equipped with this new technology, and opportunities to revise the system or seek alternatives in light of the projected costs. Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Members of the Committee.

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That Council award the contract for AVL Dashcam Solution, to DiCan in the amount of $710,523.15 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $396,840.52 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1031611 from the Capital Contingency Reserve.

3. That Council authorize Staff to renew the annual licensing, maintenance and support contract for an additional four, one-year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $649,035.84 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

4.6 OES-2023-01: Contract Award – Ajax Cricket Site Improvements

Committee Members posed questions about the history and funding of the project. D. Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Members of the Committee.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for Ajax Cricket Field Improvements, to Latitude 67 Limited in the amount of $4,367,463.56 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council award the contract for Contract Administration ~ Ajax Cricket Field Improvements, to Landscape Planning Limited in the amount of $67,800.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

3. That Council approve funding of $1,362,793.78 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1020111 from Canada Community Building Fund.

CARRIED

4.7 OES-2023-05: RFT No. 23003 – Municipal Vehicles – Brine Truck with Snowplow

Committee Members posed questions about the funding mechanism for the purchase, how many similar vehicles exist in the Town's fleet and if the new vehicle will require an increase in the Town's staffing levels to support its use in operational activities. D. Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: N. Henry

1. That Council award the contract for Municipal Vehicles ~ Brine Truck with Snowplow, to Premier Truck Group Inc. in the amount of $615,595.75 (inclusive of all taxes)

CARRIED

4.8 PDS-2023-06: Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics – Implementation Update

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report to General Government Committee, dated March 20, 2023, entitled "Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics – Implementation Update" be received for information; and

2. That Council endorse a shift from external enforcement of the corporate ban on single-use plastics, referenced in Phases III and IV of the Corporate Ban on Single-use Plastics Implementation Plan, to encouraging behavioural changes through public education and engagement initiatives.

CARRIED

4.9 PDS-2023-07: 2022 Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan: 2022 Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant Program Summary

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report to the General Government Committee, dated March 20, 2023 entitled "Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan: 2022 Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant Program Summary" be received for information.

CARRIED

4.10 PDS-2023-08: 2022 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2023 Projection Report

Committee Members sought information on whether these statistics will count towards the commitments made in the Town's Housing Pledge and the quantity of residential development that is classified as high density. Steven McReelis, Chief Building Officer/Manager of Building Approvals, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2022 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2023 Projection Report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.11 PDS-2023-09: Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement – 35-37 Kings Crescent

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement for 35-37 Kings Crescent (ATT-1) be approved.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

6.1 PDS-2023-05: Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs

Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. C. Richardson discussed programs undertaken to advance the Town's environmental sustainability portfolio including a wetland rehabilitation project on Kingston Road, the Sustainable Neighbourhood Action Program (SNAP), and updates to the Town's Urban Forest Management Plan. C. Ricardson identified energy and greenhouse gas emissions related activities and the implementation of the Ajax Green Standards to guide future site plan and subdivision applications. Finally, C. Richardson discussed the 5Rs in the waste hierarchy, achievements witnessed through the textile diversion program, and work towards eliminating single use plastics within the Town.

Committee Members posed questions respecting changes associated with the province's Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) program, the definition of single-use plastics adopted by the Town compared to definitions established by the Government of Canada, efforts underway within Town facilities to reduce single-use plastics and activities to combat phragmites within the Town's ecosystem, and feedback received as part of the Town's SNAP-related public engagement activities. C. Richardson responded to

questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the report entitled “Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update” be received for information.

CARRIED

Closed Session (3:13 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: S. Collier

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (d), (i), (j) and (k) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss labour relations or employee negotiations, a matter pertaining to a trade secret or scientific, technical, commercial, financial or labour relations information, supplied in confidence to the municipality or local board, which, if disclosed, could reasonably be expected to prejudice significantly the competitive position or interfere significantly with the contractual or other negotiations of a person, group of persons, or organization negotiations, a matter pertaining to a trade secret or scientific, technical, commercial or financial information that belongs to the municipality or local board and has monetary value or potential monetary value, and a matter pertaining to a position, plan, procedure, criteria or instruction to be applied to any negotiations carried on or to be carried on by or on behalf of the municipality or local board.

CARRIED

7.1 **Elexicon Corp Strategic Update**

7.2 **Fire Service Negotiations**

Open Meeting (4:55 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In-Camera

Moved by: S. Collier

That all directions approved during the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (4:57 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the March 20, 2023 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED